Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · GROW · Spring 2 Week 2 · Wednesday 3 March 2027 · P5

Lesson

Rehearse and refine a short performance

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Develop drama or music skills for performance.

Today I can

I can check my skill goal in two runs.

I can test one change after feedback.

I can record my choice and next step.

Prepare

For up to five pupils: books or arts logs, pencils, Monday's actual trial notes and goals if available.

Original changed-table scene lines or pupil-made quiet beat-and-gap plans.

Clear space for pairs or a group of three; no contact, costumes, devices or instruments required.

A listener may be the adult; a private or silent directed route remains available.

Store the initial plan, trial results and confirmed reflection together for the ongoing arts log.

Cover route

Retrieve genuine plans and goals or make a fresh dated test. Model focused feedback, one tested change and honest checking over two real runs. Let pupils choose drama or quiet original sound with the same change story. Rotate performer, director and listener turns, keep silent/private routes available, then record the actual goal status and next step.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: Use Monday's genuine plan and goal. If you were absent or cannot find it, make a fresh short comparison today and set a goal now. Date that starting point today. We keep the agreed quiet sound level, stop signal and private sharing option.

Look for: Prior evidence is retrieved accurately or a fresh starting point is recorded. No backfilled claim is made.

Fallback: Offer two gap lengths or turn cues; adult demonstrates and pupil confirms a goal.

Check and response: A new starting point is valid. Do not claim a previous trial or meeting of a goal without evidence.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: Rehearse only the feature first. A two-count gap can be shown silently; a turn cue can be a small hand lift. Ask the listener to notice the selected skill rather than rate the whole performance.

Look for: Pupils recall or confirm one observable goal and ask for focused feedback.

Fallback: Adult performs under the pupil's direction and the pupil selects the feature for the listener to notice.

Check and response: A focused goal can be checked: start after the cue in two runs. "Be better" needs a more precise skill to notice.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: I perform the original Keeper scene or sound pattern. The listener says, "The return began before your cue." I test a clearer hand cue, then repeat. I count one successful start, not two. Check: is my goal met if it asked for two runs? What real evidence do I still need?

Look for: Adult models honest checking, one refinement and a real second attempt. Pupils distinguish partial progress from a fully checked goal.

Fallback: Show two silent hand starts and ask pupils to point to together or early. Keep a visible count of actual runs.

Check and response: One successful start is progress but does not meet a goal of two successful starts. Complete a second real run or record the goal as still in progress.

We do 6 minutes

Say: Use the same short changed-table story. Let one person cue, one perform and one observe; in a pair, the adult can observe. Hinge: if a listener says "The gap was one count," but our plan says two, should we write two because it was planned? If anyone is unsure, model and count the real gap together before another try.

Look for: Pupils use feedback about an actual feature and record the trial honestly. They understand that a plan is different from observed evidence.

Fallback: Adult follows a pupil cue; another pupil points to one or two counts. Share privately if preferred.

Check and response: Record one count for that run. Try again if wanted. Never replace observed evidence with the intended plan. The maker decides what to change.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Use up to three short lines or a brief original beat-and-gap pattern. Keep the focus on your selected skill. Do a first run, hear one feature notice, then choose one adjustment in pace, pause, movement or cue. Try the adjusted version and check your goal. If the new choice is less useful, return to the first and explain why. Swap performer, director and listener roles so each pupil makes a real choice. Whole-class performance is optional.

Look for: A genuine rehearsal, feature-based feedback and tested refinement or justified kept choice are recorded. Each pupil contributes an intentional skill choice and checks the goal honestly. A directed piece is labelled as directed.

Fallback: Pupil directs the adult's two runs by selecting a gap or cue. Adult records the direction, observed result and exact confirmed reason. Silent hand movement can carry all cues.

Check and response: Example only: The first start was early. I made the cue clearer and we began together in the next run. My goal is partly met; I need one more successful run. Alternatively record two successes only if both occurred.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Invite a chosen listener to name one feature they saw or heard. The maker links a kept or changed choice to the intended effect. If time permits one final check, do it; otherwise record the next step honestly. Use the last two minutes to clear the space and store logs.

Look for: Pupils communicate a reasoned choice and retain feedback that actually happened. Goal status is clear.

Fallback: Adult acts as private listener and reads the confirmed choice note back. No public performance or recording is required.

Check and response: Useful reflection links a change to its purpose: the longer pause gave the new plan a clear start. A goal still in progress is a valid honest outcome.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Keep the actual plan, trial notes and confirmed reflection together. Include your art form, what you performed or directed, listener notice, choice, goal status and support. Next week we will use a short sequence about overcoming a change; a clear cue or pause can carry forward.

Look for: Dated record shows real evidence of practice and reflection, an accurate goal judgement and a concrete next step.

Fallback: Prompt one item at a time. Record a short witnessed note and let the pupil correct it. Leave an honest gap rather than filling it with the teacher model.

Check: Example only: I directed the pause. One run had two counts and one had one count. I will practise holding two counts before the final line.

Evidence and review

Keep a dated arts-log entry and a precise observation of a real trial. Record what the pupil performed or directed, the chosen feature, reason, feedback and support actually used. A photograph or recording is optional and follows local consent procedures. No supplied teacher model counts as pupil evidence.

Misconceptions

A planned skill is evidence that it happened - Keep the plan and the observation distinct. Record what really happened in each run.

Every suggestion must be used - Test one useful suggestion, then keep or change it for a reason.

A goal in progress means the piece failed - Progress and a clear next step are useful evidence of practice. Do not invent a completed goal.

Questions

foundation: What skill are you checking?

middle: What did your listener actually notice?

higher: Which evidence shows your goal is met or still in progress?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Clear a small working space. Keep both feet supported if seated. Use hands within each person's own space. No touching another performer or taking a prop from them. Sound is optional; stop on the agreed signal. Pupils can direct the adult to perform their chosen pace and movement. Record that as directed evidence, not a vocal or physical skill the pupil personally demonstrated.

Emotional and sensory access

Use the invented changed-table story. No personal story is needed. Offer seated movement, silent direction, a private adult audience and a pass on live peer performance. Voice and taps stay at talking level or below. Agree an open-hand stop signal and quiet return cue. No sudden sounds, contact, running, raised platforms, blindfolds or lifts.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Pre-teach role, pace, pause and choice with a brief model. Show one instruction at a time. Offer two pace choices, rehearse once, then fade the prompt. Use a tiny plan with beginning, change and response.

Communication And Interaction: Give processing time. Accept pointing to a pace word, signing, a phrase, a sketch or exact words scribed by an adult. Read the record back for confirmation. Do not judge accent, eye contact or facial expression.

Semh: Keep the story fictional and low stakes. A pause, a change in method or a request for help can be the character's response. Let pupils choose the role, amount of performance and audience. Follow the agreed pause-and-return route.

Sensory And Physical: Offer seated hand movement and no sound. A pupil may direct an adult voice or movement. Keep each person in their own space; use no compulsory facial expression or posture. Ask before handling a pupil's work.

Eal: Plan in any language. Explain pace as how fast we speak or move. Accept first planning in a familiar language and check the intended meaning before adding English labels. The pupil may use a short English phrase or direct a partner.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. The lesson contributes evidence towards the award; it does not confer the award. Optional next level work in GROW adds skills planning, reflection and sharing evidence for later review. It is not a separate requirement for Explore success.

Resilience can mean pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying again. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or performing through pain.

Optional next level stretch

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Task

Compare two runs of your scene or beat. What got clearer? Which change helped? Say what you kept and why. Set one small skill goal and a way to check it.

Evidence

Keep a note of both runs and your own part. Add the real feedback, your choice and reason. Add your next skill goal.

Optional scope

These extra skills, sharing and reflection records may support later work at the next level. They are optional for Explore and do not certify all requirements of the award.

Support

Pupil leads an accessible exchange, selects evidence from actual runs and explains how the feedback informed a choice or next step.

Use a private adult listener. Pupil points or speaks while adult scribes and reads the record back. Record directing separately from performing.